



Striops — meeting with the Executive Mayor

A Strategic Intelligence Operating System for the City of Cape Town. What to say, the numbers that hold up, the numbers that do not, and who to contact.

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Repository **ganyegg/striops** · commit **3acab92**

01 READ THIS FIRST

The product is in good shape and one real risk remains. The two artefact-driven claims that were headlining the Pulse — refuse complaints and streetlight faults apparently doubling in a month — are **now screened and labelled by the system itself**, and the Wins page no longer contradicts the Pulse on streetlights. What is still outstanding is deployment: the public URL serves **code from 22 July**, so none of it is live yet. Section 06 is the list. Do that, and the rest of this pack is the meeting.

15 metrics on the Pulse	10 carrying live provenance	2 flagged awaiting verification	R180k 90-day pilot, fixed
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02 THE SIXTY-SECOND ANSWER

IF THE MAYOR ASKS "WHAT EXACTLY IS THIS?"

"Striops is a Strategic Intelligence Operating System. It keeps a continuously-updated, source-linked model of the city — money, water, energy, safety, waste — and runs forecasting, risk and simulation over it to produce a daily executive brief with recommended decisions. Every number carries its source. The AI writes the prose; it never writes the arithmetic. It is not a dashboard, not a consultancy report, and not a chatbot on a data lake."

IF THE MAYOR ASKS "WHY WOULD I BUY THIS?"

"Because your quarterly reports are true on the day they are printed and stale by the time you act on them. Striops holds the same facts, refreshed continuously, and it remembers why every decision was made. Non-revenue water alone costs the City roughly R185 million a year for every percentage point of system input lost. The pilot costs R180,000. If it changes one decision by a thousandth of a percentage point, it has paid for itself."

Both answers are drawn from docs/STRIOPS.md §0 and §7 and are consistent with the pitch deck.

03 NUMBERS YOU CAN DEFEND IN THE ROOM

Every row below is live or official in the running system today, with its own period label and source. If challenged, each has a click-through in the app to the series and the publisher.

INDICATOR	LATEST PERIOD	SOURCE	STANDING
Dam storage — Cape Town system	78.2% Aug 2026	DWS weekly State of Dams	LIVE
Municipal arrears (consumer debt)	R8.95bn Mar 2026	CoCT Open Data	LIVE
System energy sent out	795,084,908 kWh May 2026	CoCT Open Data	LIVE
Electricity billed	4,182,671,921 kWh May 2026	CoCT Open Data	LIVE
Audit outcome	Unqualified — no Latest findings	AGSA via National Treasury	OFFICIAL
Population	4,772,846 Census 2022	Stats SA	OFFICIAL
Murders	324 / month Sep 2025	SAPS quarterly releases	LIVE, LAGGING
Contact crime	6,260 / month Sep 2025	SAPS quarterly releases	LIVE, LAGGING

Source: Striops /pulse and /themes, 14 Aug 2026. "Live" means fetched from the publisher, not curated by hand.

Say the crime lag out loud before anyone finds it

SAPS crime is real and it is sourced, but the latest published month in the feed is **September 2025**. If you present it beside an August 2026 dam level without saying so, it looks like you did not check. The honest line: "Crime is on a national quarterly release cycle — this is the most recent published month, and Striops labels the lag instead of hiding it. Wire the City's own precinct extract in the pilot and this becomes monthly."

04 THE MONEY CASE

This is the argument that survives a CFO. It rests on stated unit economics, not on a claim about the software.

QUANTITY	VALUEBASIS
Illustrative bulk system input	370 million~1 GL/day order of magnitude kl/yr
Blended production and pumping cost	R5.00 / klConservative; excludes retail tariff and scarcity premium
Cost of 1.0 percentage point of non-revenue water	R185m / yr370m kl × R5 × 1%
Annual cost of non-revenue water at the current level	R5.14bn / yrStriops risk valuation, confidence 0.72
Pilot fee	R180,000Fixed, 90 days, once-off
Break-even recovery	0.001 pp Held for one year, on water alone

Assumptions are published in `datasets/seed/valuation/CPT.json` and surfaced through the API at `/valuation` so the City can challenge each one.

The seeded action `act-nrw-leak-crews` targets 0.5 pp of recovery, or roughly R92.5m a year. Even at one-fiftieth of that — 0.01 pp, from earlier visibility and a named owner — the return is about R1.85m a year, roughly ten times the pilot fee, every year the gain holds.

Price ladder

TIER	PRICESCOPE
90-day pilot	R180,000Two live integrations, daily brief, provenance audit, action tracker, value once-offledger, decision register, success test
Striops Core	R95,000 /Daily brief, monitored feeds, re-verification, Pulse, actions, ledger, monthunlimited executive seats
Striops Command	R160,000 /Core plus simulation, all domains, ward-level twin, priority integrations, monthquarterly reviews

The pilot is deliberately set under the roughly R200,000 competitive-bid threshold under MFMA supply-chain practice, so it can proceed on written quotations where City policy allows. Speed is part of the offer.

Two City service series broke range in June 2026. Until this week the Pulse asserted them as month-on-month findings, which would not have survived contact with the relevant director. The system now screens them and says so. **The demo is stronger because of this, not weaker — lead with it rather than hoping nobody clicks.**

What the screen does

A reading more than twice — or less than half — the median of its own previous six periods is marked **awaiting verification** instead of being reported as a change. Those rows are dropped from the worsening and improving counts and sorted below the metrics that can defend themselves. The rule is deliberately blunt so you can restate it in one sentence in the room.

SERIES	JUNE 2026	MEDIAN, PRIOR 6	BREAKNOW SHOWN AS
Refuse service requests	28,604	11,529	2.5x AWAITING VERIFICATION
Public lighting outages	43,588	9,357	4.7x AWAITING VERIFICATION

Both break in the same month, which points at one shared cause — most likely a change in how C3 service requests are categorised or de-duplicated. The refuse extract also records 336 for September 2025, which is plainly broken and is screened on the same rule.

SAY THIS WHEN THE FLAG APPEARS ON SCREEN

“That row is the product refusing to lie to you. Refuse complaints did not treble in June — the extract changed. A quarterly report would have printed the spike as a service collapse and someone would have spent a month responding to it. Striops flags it, keeps it out of the headline counts, and tells you who to ask.”

Still do not present these two as findings

Two different dam levels, both live. The City series shows 61.35% for January 2026 and stops there; the DWS weekly series shows 78.2% for August 2026. They are seventeen points apart because they measure different things over different periods. Present the DWS figure as the current position and the City series as the City's own historical record — never side by side without that sentence. The DWS series also holds only two months so far, so its “flat” month-on-month reading establishes currency, not a trend.

The underspend amounts. The R1.21bn on Water and Sanitation and R0.88bn on Roads and Transport come from demonstration full-year function totals, not the City's official mid-year position for FY2025/26. The system labels them and so must you. Sell the method, not the amount: “this is the shape of the analysis — wire the S52 tables in the pilot and it becomes your number.”

One blocker is outstanding, and it is the important one. The code changes below it are done, tested and pushed — but none of them reach the Mayor until the site deploys.

- ① **Get the live site current. This is the whole list.** `striops-web.onrender.com` and `striops-api.onrender.com` are both serving the build from **22 July**. Everything since is on GitHub but was never deployed. Consequences today: `/themes`, `/pulse`, `/sectors`, `/risks`, `/act`, `/sources`, `/simulate`, `/briefing` and `/opportunities` all return **404** in production, the crime and census feeds are absent, the feed register shows five sources instead of nine, and the outlier screen is not running. Open the Render dashboard, find why auto-deploy stopped for both services, and redeploy from `main`. Both services build clean locally, so this is a platform question, not a code question.
- ② **Run an ingest once production is current**, so the deployed database holds the Treasury, SAPS, DWS, Census and AGSA series rather than falling back to seed. The scheduled workflow will do it, or trigger `POST /refresh?run_ingest=true` directly.
- ③ **Have a fallback demo ready regardless.** If Render cannot be fixed in time, run the current build locally and present that. Do not open the public URL as a demo while it is stale.
- ④ **Clear the two overdue actions or restate their dates.** `act-refuse-capacity` was due 30 June and `act-pipe-programme-report` 31 July. An accountability product showing its own overdue items is either an honesty asset or an unforced error, depending entirely on whether you raise it first.

Already done, pending deployment

- **Outlier screening.** Refuse and lighting are flagged as awaiting verification instead of being reported as month-on-month findings, and excluded from the headline counts.
- **The streetlight self-contradiction is resolved.** The Wins page claimed “faults falling about 2.7% per period” from a stale seed series while the Pulse read “up 116.3%”. Curated wins that cite a metric are now re-tested against that live series on every read; one whose own data no longer supports it is marked `Under review` and pushed down the page rather than left asserting the headline.
- **Dam storage is current.** The DWS weekly reading now reaches the Pulse, moving it from January to August 2026.

Turn item 5 into an asset

“Two of the five actions in here are overdue, and the system says so on its own front page. That is the point. A report cannot embarrass you in nine months' time. This can, which is why it changes behaviour.”

07 WHAT THE SYSTEM IS GENUINELY FINDING

Lead with these. They are the reason to keep talking, and each has a named owner and a rand figure already attached.

FINDING	SCORE / VALUEOWNER	STANDING
Escalating non-revenue water losses, projected past 28% next period	106 · R5.14bn/yrDirector: Water and Sanitation	CRITICAL
Growing road maintenance backlog, projected to 1,715 km	95.7 · R68mDirector: Urban Mobility avoided	CRITICAL
Lengthening clinic waiting times	92.3Community Services and Health	CRITICAL
Slower EMS response times	90.8Community Services and Health	CRITICAL

Source: Striops /risks and /health-breakdown. Clinic, EMS, non-revenue water and roads currently run on demonstration series — the mechanism is real, the inputs need the departmental extracts named in section 08.

The value ledger carries R68m on roads and R92.5m on non-revenue water, both marked projected and needs_verification. Say that plainly. Nothing is claimed as realised until a decision is taken and delivery starts, and that discipline is a selling point rather than a weakness.

08 THE ASK

Do not ask for a budget decision in the room. Ask for the two things that make the next conversation inevitable.

- 1 A data-sharing MOU covering aggregates only. No citizen personal information in scope. The specific extracts that unlock the most value: Finance S52 year-to-date operating and capital tables, and Water and Sanitation's official annual system input and zone-level non-revenue water. Those two turn the largest demonstration numbers in this pack into official ones.
- 2 A named executive sponsor and a 90-day pilot at R180,000, measured against a written success test agreed up front.

THE CLOSE

“Give me two feeds and ninety days. If at the end of it the daily brief has not changed a single decision, do not renew — and you keep the data, the exports and the schema regardless. There is no proprietary lock on your own facts.”

09 OBJECTIONS, AND THE ANSWERS

IF THEY SAY	YOU SAY
"My team can produce this report."	Once. Striops produces it every morning from live systems, every number able to defend itself, and it never forgets why a decision was made.
"Is this live City data?"	Today: curated seed plus cached public feeds — Treasury, SAPS, DWS, Stats SA and AGSA. In the pilot: Finance and Water live. The feed panel in the product always states which, per source.
"AI makes things up."	The AI writes prose only. Scores, forecasts and rand figures are deterministic and assumption-linked. Remove the API key and every number still stands.
"What about POPIA?"	Aggregates only. No citizen personal information in scope, and the MOU forbids it.
"Where does it sit?"	Pilot in South African region or hybrid; production target inside the City tenancy with single sign-on.
"What if you disappear?"	Data in the City tenancy, open exports, continuity clauses, and no proprietary formats holding your facts hostage.
"Your crime data is a year old."	Correct, and the product says so on the row. That is the national release cycle. Wire the City's precinct extract and it becomes monthly — which is precisely what the pilot is for.
"Refuse complaints did not double."	Correct, and the system already says so — that row is flagged awaiting verification and excluded from the counts, because the reading is 2.5 times the median of its own previous six months. That is an extract artefact, not a service collapse, and catching it is the argument for the whole provenance layer.
"So your data is wrong."	The City's extract changed shape; every consumer of that feed has the same problem. The difference is that we detect it and label it rather than printing it in a report. A number that can flag itself is worth more than one that cannot.

10 CONTACTS

Office of the Executive Mayor

CHANNEL	DETAIL
Executive Mayor	Ald Geordin Hill-Lewis
Office email	mayor.mayor@capetown.gov.za
Office telephone	021 400 1301 / 021 400 1300
Direct (gov.za directory)	Geordin.hillllewis@capetown.gov.za
Physical	Civic Centre, Podium Block, Fifth Floor, 12 Hertzog Boulevard, Cape Town 8001
Postal	Private Bag X9181, Cape Town 8000
City switchboard	021 400 1111
Supply chain / tenders	tenders@capetown.gov.za · 021 400 2405 / 021 400 2505

How the City requires the meeting to be requested

All meetings are scheduled at the Executive Mayor's discretion, and the published process asks for four things in writing:

1. A clear statement of your reason for wanting to meet.
2. A list of all officials you have consulted *before* requesting the meeting.
3. A proposed agenda.
4. A list of proposed attendees and their designations.

Submit by email to mayor.mayor@capetown.gov.za, or hand-deliver into the Mayor's internal post box at the Podium Block information desk, Civic Centre.

Act on point 2 first. An approach that lists Gareth Morgan and Kevin Jacoby as already consulted is materially stronger than a cold request, and it is the cheapest thing in this pack to fix.

Consult these before the Mayor

For a strategic intelligence product, the Executive Director for Future Planning and Resilience is the natural first call, and the Chief Financial Officer is the one who will interrogate the valuation method.

ROLE	NAME	WHY THEY MATTER HERE
ED: Future Planning and Resilience	Gareth Morgan	Closest institutional owner of exactly this capability — start here
City Manager	Lungelo Mbandazayo	Administrative head; any cross-directorate MOU runs through this office
CFO / ED: Finance	Kevin Jacoby	Owens the S52 tables the fiscal case needs, and will test the unit economics
ED: Water and Sanitation	Leonardo Manus	Owens system input and zone-level non-revenue water — the largest single number in the pack
ED: Urban Waste Management	Jason Mc Neil	Will immediately recognise the refuse artefact; brief before, not after
ED: Energy	Kadri Nassiep	Own-generation and plant KPIs, plus the streetlight fault series
ED: Safety and Security	Vincent Botto	LEAP and Metro Police deployment counts, still unwired
Director: Communication	Priya Reddy	Any public framing of City numbers

Mayoral Committee — portfolios that touch Striops

PORTFOLIO	MEMBER	CONTACT
Finance	Cllr Siseko Mbandezi	021 444 0958 · Siseko.Mbandezi@capetown.gov.za
Water and Sanitation	Cllr Dr Zahid Badroodien	021 444 7666 / 8448 · Zahid.Badroodien@capetown.gov.za
Urban Waste Management	Ald Grant Twigg	021 400 1218 / 072 171 1033 · grant.twigg@capetown.gov.za
Safety and Security	Cllr JP Smith	Via switchboard — email not verified
Energy	Cllr Xanthea Limberg	Via switchboard — email not verified
Urban Mobility	Cllr Roberto Quintas	Via switchboard — email not verified
Human Settlements	Cllr Carl Pophaim	Via switchboard — email not verified
Community Services and Health	Cllr Francine Higman	Via switchboard — email not verified
Economic Growth	Cllr James Vos	Via switchboard — email not verified
Corporate Services	Cllr Theresa Uys	Via switchboard — email not verified
Deputy Mayor — Spatial Planning and Environment	Ald Eddie Andrews	Via switchboard — email not verified

The three contacts above the rule were read directly from the City's own Mayoral Committee pages. The remainder are names and portfolios only. City addresses generally follow `First.Last@capetown.gov.za`, but those addresses were **not** individually verified — confirm through the switchboard on 021 400 1111 rather than guessing. Committee composition changes; re-check before sending anything.

11 WHAT IS STILL MISSING, AND SAY IT FIRST

Naming the gaps yourself is worth more than being caught by them. Each of these is a specific extract, not a vague aspiration — which is what makes the pilot scope credible.

THEME	STANDING	WHAT IS NEEDED
Water and sanitation	LIVE	Live non-revenue water and project-level wastewater treatment spend, from the Water departmental extract
Energy and grid load	LIVE	Own-generation MWh and Steenbras / IPP plant KPIs
Safety and policing	LIVE	Monthly LEAP and Metro Police deployment counts
Waste and public realm	LIVE	Nothing outstanding — but the June artefact must be resolved first
Fiscal health and revenue	PARTIAL	S52 year-to-date operating and capital tables, plus SAP Finance aggregates, so underspend becomes official mid-year FY2025/26
Housing and human settlements	PARTIAL	Monthly units delivered against target, aggregate only
Infrastructure and capital delivery	PARTIAL	Project-level capital year-to-date by vote and project
Roads and mobility	AWAITING EXTRACT	Live road-condition and backlog extract from Urban Mobility

Source: Striops / themes, 14 Aug 2026. Themes are synthesised from the Mayoral Minute 2025, the S52 report to 31 December 2025, and the 2025/26 Adjustments Budget, mapped to live feeds.

Official fiscal anchor: municipal FY2025/26, 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, with the S52 mid-year report to 31 December 2025 as the in-year reference. Any fiscal chart in the product that is not on that basis is labelled as demonstration inside the product itself.

Generated from the running Striops instance on 14 August 2026 — endpoints `/pulse`, `/themes`, `/risks`, `/opportunities`, `/valuation`, `/value-ledger`, `/actions`, `/feeds`, `/health-breakdown`. Narrative and pricing per `docs/STRIOPS.md`. Contact details read from `capetown.gov.za` and the `gov.za` contact directory on 14 August 2026 — verify before sending. Companion documents: `docs/pitch/striops-pitch.html`, `docs/STRIOPS.md`.